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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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General Comment

Allowing the use of copyrighted works to train AI would be an unmitigated disaster, both for the nation and for me personally as an artist.

The entire point of copyright is to prevent unauthorized use of creative materials, isn't it? Carving out an exception for the largest companies in the world defeats the entire purpose. Furthermore, the idea that art can be stolen and plagiarized at any time will actively depress the motivation of artists to create. Less creation means less innovation, across all creative fields, from writing to visual arts to filmmaking. That has a direct impact on our own ability to compete with other nations, in terms of economics and forward-thinking ideas.

This is all before getting to the fact that the benefits of generative AI are VASTLY overestimated. After several years and tens of billions of dollars invested in the technology, there is yet to be a single actual use case that solves some kind of problem. It has gotten to the point where companies are shoving their AI tools into unrelated products, making them less reliable, just to claim that more people are using AI. This is an enormously expensive solution in search of a problem, and just like NFTs before, the bubble will burst and leave economic disaster in its wake.

Please don't add to this disaster by undercutting one of the only protections that artists and creatives have under our current system. The bottom line is that allowing AI companies unrestricted access to our work will do incalculable damage to an already unstable industry while offering absolutely nothing in return. Artists don't want it, consumers don't want it, the American people don't want it.